

Put the Team Before Yourself: Introduction, Featuring Dr. Keith Gray

Keith Gray, Senior Vice President & Chief Medical Officer, University Health Systems, Inc.

The word “family” signifies a tight bond. In a literal sense, it applies to your relatives, but it can also speak to a deeper connection among friends and colleagues. You have your family of origin, and you have the family you choose. These are the people who form your support network, the ones you turn to when you want to share life’s joys and trials.

While being in a family has its rewards, it also comes with conflict. The people you lean on the most are often the ones who hold your highest regard and your highest expectations.

Pat Summitt considered teamwork to be a lot like being in a family. A team shares goals, responsibilities, arguments and heartbreak. It can be hard to stay in sync with the bigger picture while working through differences; but when a team is fully committed, greatness is possible. Working together, ordinary people can do extraordinary things.

Coach Pat Summitt

“Teamwork is really a form of trust. It’s what happens when you realize that you wouldn’t achieve your individual goals without the support of your colleagues.”

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So how do you get people to shift from thinking only about themselves to sacrificing for the greater good? How do you lead distinct personalities to practice compromise and collaboration? Pat cultivated a team-oriented mindset among her players every day because she knew that unchecked ego and jealousy could dismantle even the most talented collection of athletes. She was a master at harnessing the power of differing perspectives, backgrounds, and abilities into a shared and intensive focus directed toward excellence.

In this module, you’ll hear from Virginia Means, the chief people officer of United Distributors, where she oversees all aspects of human capital strategy and operations, including talent acquisition and development.

Virginia will teach you the basic principles and methods Pat used to help her players adopt a team mentality. After these modules, you will know what it takes to lead a group of highly talented individuals toward shared success.